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In memoriam Helmut Rix (1926-2004)

a cura di Giovanna Rocca



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INDIRIZZI DEGLI AUTORI

Brent Vine

UMBRIAN *DISLERALINSUST*

1. The general meaning of Umbrian *disleralinsust* (VIa 7, 3 sg. fut. II) is clear from its context, which details certain regulations that govern the taking of the auspices. The immediately preceding passage (VIa 5-7) enjoins that while the ceremony is being conducted, no noise shall be made and no unauthorized person shall "sit in the way" (and thus, presumably, cause a disruption).[1] The text continues (VIa 7):

> *sue . muieto . fust . ote . pisi . arsir . andersesusp{.}disleralinsust*
> "If a noise is made or any other person sits in the way, *disleralinsust.*"[2]

The word refers, then, to the effect on the ceremony if the prohibited actions were to occur – i.e., as is usually assumed, the ceremony would be invalidated (and therefore, by implication, would need to be repeated): hence the standard interpretations along these lines, e.g., "inritum fecerit"[3] or "he will make (the ceremony) invalid";[4] so also more recently Ancillotti and Cerri (1996, p. 298),[5] Untermann (2000, p. 180),[6] Dupraz (2009, p. 249),[7] and Weiss (2010, p. 215).[8]

[1] For discussion of the context, see most conveniently POULTNEY 1959, pp. 232f.

[2] *andersesusp* is an error for *andersesust*, and there is no word-dividing punct between this word and the next. Translation after POULTNEY (but omitting his interpretation for *disleralinsust,* on which see below).

[3] BUCK 1928, p. 263, VETTER 1953, p. 230 (both following BUECHELER).

[4] POULTNEY 1959, p. 232.

[5] "si avrà un vizio di forma".

[6] "im Bereich von 'fehlgehen' nach einer Störung der Auspizien".

[7] "il aura invalidé [la cérémonie]", with reference (249 n82) to MEISER 1986, p. 211 ("er wird den Spruch … fehlgehend = ungültig machen") and GARCÍA CASTILLERO 2000, p. 285 ("(la ceremonia, el augurio) será inútil, quedará sin efecto").

[8] "The general sense must therefore be something like: if a noise is made or if another sits in between, then the taking of the auspices will have become void."

2. The morphological interpretation of the word is clear only up to a point. The final sequence *-ust* unambiguously reflects the *futurum exactum* suffix *-us-* followed by the 3 sg. active desinence *-t* (cf. U. **purtinçus**/*purdinsiust, purdinsust* 'he will have offered', among other such forms). The preceding *-ns-* is also identifiable: this is one of the regular allomorphs of the Umbrian perfect formation often referred to as the "*-nki̯-*perfect" (as in the example just cited); the formal details are somewhat complex,[9] but the identification in these terms of *-ns-* (in *disleralinsust*) is secure. Continuing leftward: the preceding *-i-* clearly reflects the present stem vowel, pointing, in other words, to a *-i̯e/o-*formation that has generally (though not universally) been assumed to be denominative. Thus the basic morphological breakdown of *-insust* (i.e., as *-i-ns-us-t*) is transparent. Everything that precedes this, however, is a matter of controversy.

The word is sometimes simply dismissed as obscure, beyond the basic grammatical identifications just given.[10] Otherwise, there are essentially two approaches to interpreting the sequence *disleral-*; these can be summarized (with some appended critique) as follows.[11]

2.1. According to a suggestion of Buecheler, which has been widely accepted,[12] U. *disleralinsust* is to be compared with Lat. *līra* 'furrow' (< **leisā*) and in particular its derived denominative *dēlīrāre* 'to stray from the furrows, go off track', whence metaphorically 'to be out of one's mind' (cf. *dēlīrus* 'insane'). The Umbrian verb would be based on a prefix *dis-* 'away from' and a derived adjective **leisāli-* 'pertaining to a furrow, track', whence a denominative **dis-leisāli-i̯e/o-* 'go off track', in this case with regard to the ritual: thus 'perform [the ritual] improperly' (or intransitively: 'be improperly performed').[13] A suggestive comparison, finally, is the well-attested Latin spelling *dēlērāre*,[14] often assumed

[9] See in detail WILLI 2010, with earlier literature.

[10] Thus, e.g., WILLI 2010, p. 2 ("of uncertain meaning and etymology").

[11] For much of the earlier literature on U. *disleralinsust*, I refer globally to UNTERMANN 2000, p. 181 (s.v.) for bibliographical details.

[12] VON PLANTA, BUCK, ERNOUT, PISANI, POULTNEY, among others (see UNTERMANN s.v.); more recently, e.g., ANCILLOTTI – CERRI (1996, p. 351).

[13] So also, as it seems, DE VAAN 2008, p. 171 (s.v. *dis-*), though tentatively.

[14] So also in derivatives: e.g., *dēlēritās* 'madness' (Laber. 138 Ribb).

to reflect a dialectal monophthongization and thus explicitly associated with U. *disleralinsust*.[15]

But this theory is distinctly unattractive in several important respects. It has often been noted, to begin with,[16] that the prefix *dis-* is not otherwise attested in Umbrian (or, for that matter, anywhere else in Sabellic), and that in any case, one would expect to see a prefixed element corresponding to Lat. *dē-*. Moreover, as argued most recently by Weiss,[17] this proposal faces the further difficulty that Lat. *dēlīrus, dēlīrāre* are undoubtedly hypostatic formations based on prepositional phraseology (**dē līrād [īre]* '[to go] off the track'), whereas *dis-* (as far as can be seen from its behavior in Latin) never had prepositional force – a problem already seen (but in no way solved) by Buecheler. Weiss's final objection is also a serious one, namely that *dēlīrāre* "has no technical religious meaning in Latin".

2.2. Authorized in part by the lack of word division before *disleralinsust* (cf. n. 2 above), as well as relatively frequent instances of this kind elsewhere in the text, a second approach – also of long standing, and currently the most popular[18] – operates with a word division *disler{.}alinsust.* There are several variants of this hypothesis, with differing interpretations of both forms. Most commonly, *disler* is taken as gen. sg. or abl. pl. of U. **tiçel**, **tiçlu** '(spoken) formula, speech act', and *alinsust* (< **al-ī-nkᵢ̯-us-t*) is said to belong with Gk. ἀλάομαι 'wander',[19] hence 'stray from the formula(s)' = 'render the ceremony invalid'. Alternatively (to cite the most prominent variants), *alinsust* has been connected to the roots of ὄλλυμι 'destroy'[20] and (assuming a preverb *ā-*[21]) λύω 'release, loose'.[22] A

[15] See, e.g., ERNOUT-MEILLET 363 (s.v. *līra*).

[16] See, e.g., VETTER 1953, p. 233 (ad loc.).

[17] WEISS 2010, p. 216 n260.

[18] AUFRECHT – KIRCHHOFF, BRÉAL, DEVOTO, VETTER, among others; more recent adherents will be noted below.

[19] To the root of ἀλάομαι also U. *amboltu* 'he shall go around', cf. Lat. *ambulāre* 'walk' and perhaps *pālor* 'wander' (see DE VAAN 2008, pp. 38, 441).

[20] Thus DEVOTO in various publications, followed by SCHIRMER 1998, pp. 109f.; to this root also Lat. *abolēre, dēlēre* 'destroy', perhaps among other forms.

[21] Cf. U. *ahauendu* 'he shall avert', O. **aamanaffed** 'locavit, mandavit', etc. (see UNTERMANN 2000, pp. 41f.).

[22] GARCÍA CASTILLERO 2000, pp. 285f.; to this root also Lat. *luere* 'suffer, atone

final twist to be noted is Weiss's proposal,[23] according to which *disler* belongs with a word U. **tiçel** 'day', a supposed homonym of **tiçel** 'speech act'; thus 'stray from the day' = 'invalidate the day, render the day null and void' – cf. superficially comparable Roman formulas of the sort *diem vitiare, diem tollere*. Some of the difficulties with this general approach were discussed by Poultney,[24] who noted that forms of **tiçel** occur nowhere else in the Latin-alphabet portion of the text, and that the contexts in which this word appears do not in any case support the claimed meaning of *disler* in a phrase *disler{.}alinsust*.[25] Weiss's 'day' would not face this objection; but in the final analysis, his 'stray from the day' (assuming, as he does, that *alinsust* belongs with ἀλάομαι, etc.) is not convincing, and does not match the expression of the Roman parallels he cites.[26] Poultney further observed that "the real difficulty is in finding any satisfactory etymology for *alinsust*", a problem that has, if anything, only become more recalcitrant since Poultney's time. As well discussed by Martzloff in a thorough treatment of the morphology of *alinsust*,[27] U. **al-ī-* can be interpreted as a "3rd-*iō* conjugation" form (**al-i-*) or a "4th conjugation" form (**al-ī-*),[28] or even as a "2nd conjugation" iterative in **-e̯i̯e/o-* (which would also yield **alī-*).[29] Yet as Weiss points out, no type of *i̯e/o*-verb matches the *a verbo* of ἀλάομαι and its cognates (and the same observation applies, *mutatis mutandis,* to ὄλλυμι and λύω[30]); and moreover, as discussed by both García Castillero and Martzloff, it is not easy to justify a perfect in *-nki̯-* for any sort of primary verb.

In short, both of the standard approaches to U. *disleralinsust* incorporate serious difficulties.

for', *solvere* 'release'. Note also MARTZLOFF 2006, p. 622, suggesting a connection with Lat. *polluere* 'defile'.

[23] WEISS 2010, pp. 215f.

[24] POULTNEY 1959, p. 233 (ad loc.).

[25] Similarly WEISS (2010, p. 216), on the alleged meaning 'formula': "*disler* could not mean formula since it is not a question of just a formula being invalid but the whole *auspicium*."

[26] 'day' + 'destroy' (with *alinsust* ~ ὄλλυμι) might be more attractive semantically (cf. Lat. *diem vitiare*); but it is doubtful that any relevant formation built to PIE **h₃elh₁-* could end up with synchronic /al-/ in Umbrian. (See further below on the morphology of U. *al-ĭ,* and compare U. *holtu* 'she shall destroy [?]', if it belongs with ** h₃elh₁-*.)

[27] MARTZLOFF 2006, pp. 620ff.

[28] See MEISER 1986, p. 211 for these two possibilities.

[29] MEISER 2003, pp. 68, 70 n124.

[30] With ὄλλυμι, to be sure, belongs ** h₃elh₁-é̯i̯e/o-* (e.g., Lat. *abolēre*); but see n. 26 above on the difficulty of aligning such a form with the *a*-vocalism of *alinsust.*

3. A fresh approach to the background of U. *disleralinsust* begins from a comparison with the Germanic root **lais*- (zero grade **lis*-) in words for 'teach', 'learn' and related concepts, as in

(i) Go. *(ga)laisjan* 'teach' (: OE *lǣran*/OS *lērian*/OHG *lēren*, etc. 'id.'), reflexive *(ga)laisjan sik* 'learn', preterito-present *lais* 'I know' (*'I have learned');

(ii) OE *leornian*, OHG *lernēn,* etc. 'learn' (< Gmc. **liznō-*/**lizna*-);

(iii) OE *lár*, OHG *lēra* (< Gmc. **laizō* 'lore, teaching'), among other nominal formations.[31]

Traditionally,[32] this material is considered to belong with a root **leis*- '(follow a?) track',[33] as precisely in Lat. *līra* and *dēlīrus, dēlīrāre* (cf. **2.1** above), as well as OCS *lěxa* 'cultivated plot' (and similar Baltic material), and various forms in Germanic in this semantic field, such as Go. *laists*, OE *lāst* 'footstep, track', OHG *wagan-leisa* 'wagon track', etc. This conception is still widely assumed, in both IE handbooks[34] and more specialized works on Germanic.[35] Yet the presumed connection between the 'teach, learn' words (thus far attested only in Germanic) and those for 'track, furrow, planting bed (etc.)' (Germanic, Italic, BaltoSlavic) is anything but certain, as shown by Benveniste well over a half century ago in a detailed study of the problem (1947-48) that is now, regrettably, almost entirely ignored.

Benveniste disputed the connection between these two sets of forms with an analysis that was taken seriously by Seebold (loc. cit.), and which in my view is entirely persuasive. Benveniste's full argumentation, mainly of a semantic and distributional nature, need not be recapitulated in full, but his reasoning can be summarized briefly as follows. In general, Benveniste rejects the notion that words with meanings as disparate as (for example) 'furrow', 'cunning', 'learn', and 'continue' can be subsumed in a facile way under a single root **leis*- with a meaning like 'follow a track'. Grouped in terms of semantics, one can isolate, to begin

[31] See most usefully the survey by SEEBOLD (1970, pp. 322f).

[32] Among older handbooks, see in particular IEW 671 (s.v. **leis*-), BUCK 1949, p. 1222.

[33] Or, similarly, '± leave a trace on the ground' (MALLORY – ADAMS [2006, p. 168], who likewise operate with a root **leis*-). Somewhat differently 'go (a troublesome way)', whence perf. 'I have gone the way, experienced, learned to know' (MEID, see TANAKA 2011:124).

[34] See, e.g., WATKINS 2001, p. 48, LIV s.v. **leis*-.

[35] See, e.g., CASARETTO 2004, pp. 454, 502; TANAKA 2011, pp. 122ff.

with, an original agricultural term, exclusively nominal in Italic and Balto-Slavic ('furrow', 'garden plot') and with nominal and verbal derivatives in Germanic ('wagon track', 'footstep', whence denominative verbs with meanings like 'follow, pursue, continue', etc.). In contrast, forms meaning 'teach', 'learn' (thus fundamentally verbal, with nominal derivatives like Go. *lists* 'strategem', *listigs* 'cunning', etc.) are attested exclusively in Germanic. The traditional supposition that 'teach, learn' derives from a meaning like 'follow a track' has absolutely no support. On the one hand, the 'track' words never show any derived abstract senses that cannot be immediately understood on the basis of concrete meanings like 'track' or 'footstep'. In contrast, the purely Germanic 'teach, learn' words never deviate from this basic abstract sense: these words "dénotent spécifiquement l'effort mental d' 'apprendre' et le savoir acquis par l'exercice spirituel, à l'exclusion de toute opération matérielle" (Benveniste 1947-48:3). The two sets of forms are therefore irreconcilable, and the notion of (for example) 'learn' < *'follow a track' constitutes an illegitimate leap that has no support in the data.[36]

I believe it is possible to offer two additional arguments, this time of a formal nature, to Benveniste's mainly semantic analysis. The first involves the parallel existence of two well-attested *ti*-stem abstracts in Germanic: **lais-ti-* (Go. *laists* 'track', ON *leistr* 'foot below the ankle, short sock', OE *lāst* 'sole, footstep', etc.) beside **lis-ti-* (Go. *lists* 'strategem', ON/OE/OS/OHG *list* 'skill, cunning'). Again, there is not the slightest semantic overlap between these two formally distinct items, and little reason to suppose that **lais-ti-* (with its clearly innovative *o*-grade vocalism) preserves the archaic concrete semantics,[37] while the more formally archaic *ti*-stem with zero grade shows the newer meaning.[38] Secondly, the two roots in question may be formally (as well as semanti-

[36] I refer to BENVENISTE's discussion for many additional details, in particular about the Germanic material.

[37] Thus, e.g., CASARETTO 2004, pp. 454, 502.

[38] An appeal to KURYLOWICZ's "Fourth Law of Analogy" (TANAKA 2011, p. 125 n172) is unattractive in a pattern of this kind (where there is absolutely no semantic overlap, not only in these forms but in all other 'track' vs. 'teach, learn' forms, as discussed above); nor, given the basic *o*-vocalism well-attested in Gmc. **laisō* 'track, trace, furrow, split' (OHG *wagan-leisa* 'wagon track', *lesa* 'split', etc.), is it attractive to suggest (with TANAKA) that the *o*-grade of **lais-ti-* 'track' is due to the earlier existence of an old perfect or preterito-present with *o*-grade (otherwise attested only in Go. *lais* 'know, have learned').

cally) distinct, in another respect: it is a striking fact that for the concrete 'track, furrow' words, *e*-grade **leis*- forms (such as Lat. *līra*) are attested with certainty, whereas for 'teach, learn', there is virtually no evidence for *e*-grade. The sole *e*-grade 'teach, learn' form appears in Go. *lubja-leisei* 'φαρμακεία' (Gal. 5.20), cf. *lubjaleis* glossing *liutai* 'γόητες' (2 Tim. 3.13); but this word is almost certainly modeled on *X-weis* compounds (*un-weis,* **fulla-weis,* etc.), cf. preterito-present *wait* → *lais* itself.[39] Otherwise, for 'teach, learn' one finds (apart from the Gmc. **lais*- forms in (i) and (iii) above) only zero grades, such as (in addition to (ii) above) the words for 'strategem, cunning' already cited (Go. *lists,* etc.), as well as OE *gelis* '(religious) knowledge'.

4. The ability to appeal to a distinct root that means 'teach, learn' or the like allows one to avoid most (or possibly all) of the difficulties that undermine the analysis of U. *disleralinsust* based on the '(follow a?) track' root (**2.1**).

In pursuing such an alternative, a systematic morphological correspondence between U. *disleralinsust* and at least some of the Germanic material would clearly be superior to a mere root etymology. If we retain the basic morphological assumptions of the traditional analysis based on Lat. *līra* 'furrow' (**2.1**), according to which the presumed basis is a feminine *ā*-stem noun (U. **(-)lerā*-), it is immediately encouraging that U. **(-)lerā*- finds a direct counterpart (at least as regards its morphological formation) in Gmc. **laizō* 'teaching, instruction, lore' (**3.**(iii)).[40] In brief, and with various details to be discussed (and slightly adjusted) below, we therefore offer the following preliminary hypothesis:

(i) U. **lerā*- 'teaching, instruction, lore'[41] = Gmc. **laizō* 'id.';

(ii) **lerā*- → adj. **lerā-li*- 'pertaining to [~ according to] teaching, instruction' (or perhaps 'according to the ritual');[42]

[39] At least according to BENVENISTE (1947-48, p. 4); we return to this point below. For Go. *X-weis* → *X-leis*: see, e.g., HEIDERMANNS 1993, p. 371.

[40] See further **5.** below on the root vocalism and the apparently anomalous treatment of the initial **l*- in Umbrian.

[41] Or perhaps, at some stage of Umbrian or pre-Umbrian, specialized as 'rite, ritual'. (The rhotacism of intervocalic **s*- is of course regular in Umbrian; BUCK 1928, p. 74).

[42] Thus an instance of "basic **li*-" to an *ā*-stem (cf. Lat. *viālis* ← *via* 'road', etc.) – evidently an archaic pattern, in view of the early generalization of productive "*-ālis*" (LEUMANN 1977, p. 351), including Umbrian: e.g. *uerfale* (on which see DE VAAN 2008, p. 643, s.v. *urbs,* for discussion and references).

(iii) **lerā-li-* → **dis-lerāli-* 'contrary to instruction/ritual, improper', via "negative *dis-*" (treated below);

(iv) **dis-lerāli-* → **dislerāli-i̯e/o-* 'be contrary to instruction/ritual, be (ritually) improper', whence 3 sg. fut. II *disleralinsust* 'it will have been contrary to instruction/ritual', hence ritually improper and (therefore) invalid, entailing repetition of the ceremony.

For the semantics: beyond the obvious improvement over the conception involving terminology like Lat. *līra* and *dēlīrāre*, note further Benveniste's suggestion, based on the actual usage of some of the Germanic forms, that this material fundamentally involves not just "la connaissance d'un savoir", but most likely "un savoir … de nature magique" (1947-48:5). The Umbrian usage, in its ritual context, offers a striking complement to that proposal.

5. Several important features remain unaccounted for, and primary among these is the root vocalism: Go. *laisjan* and its cognates are generally taken to continue the *o*-grade causative **lois-éi̯e/o-* of a primary verb,[43] and Gmc. **laizō* is normally assumed to continue an *o*-grade feminine abstract **loiséh*$_2$ (i.e., a "τομή" form) that is "post-verbal" to the causative.[44] The interpretation of the Germanic material will concern us directly. But the most basic issue is its apparent *o*-vocalism: specifically, a preform **loiséh*$_2$ will not produce (New) Umbrian *(-)lerā-,* the root vowel of which can only reflect earlier **ei* or **ai.* There are, nevertheless, two methods of justifying a formal match between U. *(-)lerā-* and Gmc. **laizō*. Each one carries with it certain subsidiary complications, but both have the potential to account independently for other difficulties, beyond the question of the root vocalism, besetting the Umbrian form.

5.1. Although, as just mentioned, some of the Germanic material is traditionally interpreted in terms of original *o*-grades, the matter is not as clear-cut as it seems at first glance. There is, first of all, no necessity to interpret Gmc. **laizō* as postverbal to an old causative. Benveniste interprets Go. *laisjan* etc. as fundamentally denominative (1947-48:2), a pos-

[43] So, for example, PROKOSCH 1938, p. 153, 189; GUXMAN et al. 1966, p. 411; SEEBOLD 1970, p. 323; LIV (s.v. **leis-*); RINGE 2006, p. 217 (on the Verner's voicing); TANAKA 2011, p. 123.

[44] So explicitly SEEBOLD (loc. cit.), CASARETTO 2004, p. 427, among others.

sibility also admitted by others;[45] and this, in turn, is related to the controversial question of the antiquity of the preterito-present Go. *lais*. Recent treatments[46] continue to favor the idea that Go. *lais* is an archaic form, with *laisjan* its derived causative. But all such treatments ignore Benveniste's important discussion (1947-48:4) of *lais,* an absolute hapax that occurs just after *galaisida mik* (Phil. IV.11-12), and which therefore (as already seen by Meillet) stands a good chance of being a nonce-form modeled on *wait* and created to *galaisjan sik*; cf. also the clearly secondary fientive **liznō-*/**lizna-* (**3.**(ii)), restricted to West Germanic. There is thus no hard and fast evidence for verbal *o*-grades, or even for the existence of a primary verb; and if we couple this with (a) the absence of clear evidence for *e*-grades of any kind (**3.**), (b) the possibility that the most archaic form might well be the feminine abstract Gmc. **laizō* 'lore', and (most generally) (c) Benveniste's demonstration that the root of the Germanic 'teach, learn' words may well be distinct from the **leis-* of the 'track, furrow' words, we arrive at the possibility of setting up a root **lais-,* with basic *a*-vocalism, for Gmc. **laizijanan* and **laizō*.[47] In this way, a preform **lais-éh*$_2$ produces both Gmc. **laizō* and U. *-lerā-* directly.

This leaves two remaining problems, both of them often noted in connection with the traditional solution via the 'track, furrow' root. First, as already noted (**2.1**), is the disquieting fact that a prefix *dis-* is not otherwise attested in Sabellic. Second, and sometimes explained with reference to the first point, is the fact that initial **l-* in Umbrian should develop to **u̯-*.[48] There is, however, a simple and attractive solution that simultaneously accounts for both of these problems and which can also be aligned with another formal feature of the word, namely its **-li-* forma-

[45] E.g., GUXMAN et al. 1966, p. 171.

[46] See the detailed discussion in TANAKA 2011, pp. 122f.; more concisely, but along similar lines, RINGE 2006, pp. 253, 261.

[47] If one admits the possibility of ablauting *o*-grades for roots with basic *a*-vocalism, one could even suppose that Go. *laisjan* etc. actually continue an *o*-grade causative. (I leave aside here various laryngealistic methods of rewriting PIE "**lais-*", as would be called for by "Leiden School" scholars and others who do not accept the existence of PIE *a*-vocalism).

[48] See in extenso MEISER 1986, pp. 155ff., and note the prefixed form U. *anderuomu* 'he shall wash', if the connection with Lat. *lavere* is correct (see UNTERMANN 2000, pp. 866f., s.v. **vutu**). One must thus resort to extreme chronological assumptions about the age of the *dis*-formation in order to account for U. *disleralinsust* via prefixed *dis-* and an initial *l* that escaped the regular Umbrian velarization.

tion: that is, the hypothesis that the word (or at least its lexical basis) is not actually Umbrian in origin, but rather a borrowing from dialectal Latin.[49] Note first that the phonology is perfectly in order: a well-attested feature of dialectal Latin, securely documented in Umbrian territory, is monophthongization of **ai* to <E> (presumably [ē]) in initial syllables: cf., among other such early forms, Lat. CEDRE, CEDITO = *caed(e)re, caedito* (CIL I^2 366, Spoletum), CESULA = *Caesula* (CIL I^2 376, Pisaurum).[50] A basis in Latin, moreover, not only explains prefixed *dis-,* but also accounts directly for the derivational pattern with "negative *dis-*" prefixed to an adjectival **-li-* form, precisely where this pattern is best attested: thus **dis-lērāli-* like Lat. **dis-fakli-* (> *difficilis* 'difficult'), **dis-semali-* (> *dissimilis* 'unlike').[51] Finally, the surface sequence *dis-l*^{o} (for expected *dīl*^{o}, cf. Lat. *dīlacerāre* 'tear apart', etc.) can be interpreted to show restored *dis-* in a formal context, as in Lat. DISMOTA (SCBacch). The only purely Umbrian part of the word, then, may be the derivation as a denominative verb.

5.2. An alternative method of supporting a formal match between U. *(-)lerā-* and Gmc. **laizō* begins by retaining the assumption of an original *o*-grade **lois-éh$_2$* for both forms. In this case, and assuming once again a Latin basis, one may point to two Latin processes that unround **oi* to **ei* in initial syllables, i.e.

(i) **(C)loiP-* > /(C)leiP-/ (where P = any labial consonant);[52]

[49] On the question of Latin influence on Sabellic, including lexical borrowing, see in general ADAMS 2003, pp. 155f. (here also with reference to the Oscanized version of Lat. *dolo malo*). Apart from borrowed cultural terms (especially prominent with official titles: U. **kvestur**, etc.), the verbal stem U. **kura-** 'look after' (cf. also Pael. *coisatens*) has long been thought to be an early borrowing from Latin to Sabellic (UNTERMANN 2000, p. 407; WILLI 2010, p. 9 registers skepticism about this claim, which may well be justified, though the general point about the possibility of lexical borrowing in this direction remains valid).

[50] On the material in Umbrian territory, see ADAMS 2007, pp. 85ff. (who does not distinguish between monophthongization in initial/medial as opposed to final position: thus also, if one includes the latter, CIL I^2 376 DIANE = *Dianae,* etc.). It is of no consequence, for the present analysis, whether (as is often thought) these forms are due to influence from an Umbrian substrate, or whether (as ADAMS prefers, 2007, pp. 108ff.) they reflect a "native" feature of dialectal Latin itself.

[51] On "negative *dis-*", see DE VAAN 2008, p. 172 (s.v. *dis-*) for discussion and references.

[52] See, e.g., WEISS 2009, pp. 102f. (Lat. *clīvus, līmus,* etc.).

(ii) **u̯oi-* > /u̯ei-/.[53]

In both cases, one would then posit the dialectal monophthongization **ei* > [ē], for which the best-documented example in non-final position is in fact VECVS = *vīcus,* principally found (apart from the testimony of ancient authorities) in the area of the Lacus Fucinus.[54] Further, for (i): the structural description of the process does not quite match the sequence **lois-,* which lacks a labial consonant following the diphthong. One could speculate, however, that the process postdates rhotacism (or at least persisted until that time), and that – perhaps only dialectally – the resulting /r/ contained sufficient lip-rounding (a common feature of rhotic approximants, as in Eng. /r/ for many speakers) in order for the rule to operate. For (ii): one would need to assume, perhaps not unreasonably, that in the Latin dialect in question, initial **l-* (in **loi-*) was sufficiently velarized (cf. **l-* > /u̯-/ in Umbrian) for the following diphthong to undergo the unrounding process normally described as **u̯oi-* > /u̯ei-/; thus here **łoi-* > /lei-/.

5.3. As a final bit of speculation relating to the various monophthongizations discussed in **5.1** and **5.2**: it is theoretically possible that the Latin *dēlēr-* forms (**2.1** and n. 54) actually reflect a contamination of *dēlīrāre* 'go off the track' and **dīlērā(lis)* 'improper'; cf. the frequent confusion of *dē-* and *dī-* in forms like *dēlēctus/dīlēctus* 'choice'.[55]

6. To be sure, both of the approaches outlined in **5.2** call for special assumptions, which rest on little direct evidence. These are the cost, in other words, of maintaining a preform with original *o*-grade inherited by both Italic and Germanic – a cost that would need to be weighed against the assumption of original *a*-vocalism (as in **5.1**). But whether one opts for an explanation along the lines of **5.1** (original *a*-vocalism) or **5.2** (original *o*-vocalism), both versions offer significant gains in explanatory power for the problems surrounding U. *disleralinsust*; these gains include:

[53] See, e.g., WEISS 2009, p. 143 (Lat. *vīcus* and dialectal VECVS; see directly below in the text).

[54] For details, see ADAMS 2007, pp. 56f., 138, 173. Compare also Lat. *dēlēr-* (**2.1**).

[55] ERNOUT-MEILLET 349 (s.v. *legō*).

(i) a highly natural semantic interpretation, based on a root for 'teach, learn' (hitherto attested only in Germanic);

(ii) a possible direct morphological correspondence between U. *-*lerā*- and Gmc. **laizō* 'instruction, lore';

(iii) direct support for the complete morphological profile of U. *disler-ali-,* via a basis in dialectal Latin and by comparison with Lat. *dis-...-li-* adjectives formed with "negative *dis-*".[56]

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